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sufficient cash flows from operations or that future borrowings will be available from additional indebtedness or otherwise to meet our liquidity needs. Although we have no specific current plans to do so, if we decide to pursue one or more significant acquisitions, we may incur additional debt or sell additional equity to finance such acquisitions.

Cash Flows

The following table provides a summary of cash flows from operating, investing and financing activities (in millions):

	Year ended December 31,			Variance	
	2019	2018	2017	2019 v. 2018	2018 v. 2017
Cash flows provided by operating activities	\$ 378.3	\$ 435.5	\$ 351.1	\$ (57.2)	\$ 84.4
Cash flows used in investing activities	(551.0)	(144.1)	(84.7)	(406.9)	(59.4)
Cash flows provided by (used in) financing activities	167.8	(287.3)	(384.1)	455.1	96.8
Net (decrease) increase in cash and cash equivalents	<u>\$ (4.9)</u>	<u>\$ 4.1</u>	<u>\$ (117.7)</u>	<u>\$ (9.0)</u>	<u>\$ 121.8</u>

Operating Activities

The \$57.2 million decrease in cash provided by operating activities in 2019 compared to 2018 is primarily related to the timing and amount of cash receipts for Trade receivables, net, higher payments primarily related to income taxes and incentive bonus, and the timing of payments for Trade accounts payable and other accrued liabilities. The \$84.4 million increase in cash provided by operating activities in 2018 compared to 2017 was primarily related to increased earnings excluding the prior year effect of the Tax Reform Act and the timing and amount of cash receipts for Trade receivables, net.

Investing Activities

The \$406.9 million increase in cash used in investing activities in 2019 compared to 2018 is primarily related to our D&B Investment and our acquisition of Compass Analytics. The \$59.4 million increase in cash used in investing activities in 2018 compared to 2017 was primarily related to the HeavyWater and Ernst acquisitions and higher capital expenditures in 2018.

Financing Activities

The \$455.1 million increase in cash provided by financing activities in 2019 compared to 2018 is primarily related to an incremental borrowing to fund our D&B Investment as well as fewer share repurchases. The \$96.8 million decrease in cash used in financing activities in 2018 compared to 2017 was primarily related to tax distributions to BKFS LLC members and the senior notes redemption fee in 2017.

Financing

For a description of our financing arrangements, see Note 12 to the Notes to Consolidated Financial Statements included in Item 8 of Part II of this Report, which is incorporated by reference into this Part II Item 7.

Contractual Obligations

Our long-term contractual obligations generally include our debt and related interest payments, data processing and maintenance commitments and operating and finance lease payments for our offices, data centers, property and equipment. These long-term contractual obligations extend through 2024.